GOOGLE CLOUD SKILLS | HANDS-ON LAB REPORT

Cloud Storage: Qwik Start Google Cloud Console

Qwik Starts series · Lab ID: GSP073

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DATE COMPLETED	15 October 2026
PLATFORM	Google Cloud (Cloud Storage)
LEVEL / DURATION	Introductory / 10 minutes
FINAL SCORE	100 / 100

1. Overview

Cloud Storage provides worldwide storage and retrieval of any amount of data at any time. Typical uses include serving website content, archival and disaster-recovery storage, and distributing large objects through direct download. Data lives in **buckets**, the basic containers in Cloud Storage, and each piece of data stored in a bucket is an **object**.

In this lab I used the Google Cloud console to create a bucket, upload objects, organise them in folders, and make them publicly accessible.

2. Objectives

- Create a storage bucket
- Upload objects to the bucket
- Create folders and subfolders in the bucket
- Make objects in a storage bucket publicly accessible

3. Resources Built

Setting	Value
Bucket name	qwiklabs-gcp-04-45733511bc6b (the project ID, which is globally unique)
Location type / location	Region / asia-southeast1 (Singapore)
Default storage class	Standard
Access control	Uniform (public access prevention turned off)
Created	15 October 2026, 1:04:55 PM (UTC+5:30)
Objects	kitten.png (132.9 KB, image/png); folder1/ (with a subfolder); Website/ (static site files)
Public access	Access granted to public principals (allUsers: Storage Object Viewer)

The bucket and its resources were temporary and were removed when the lab ended.

4. Step-by-Step Walkthrough

Task 1 – Create a bucket

In the console I opened *Navigation menu* > *Cloud Storage* > *Buckets* and clicked **Create**. I named the bucket with the project ID because bucket names are global and must be unique, chose **Region** with **asia-southeast1** as the location, **Standard** as the default class, **Uniform** access control, and unchecked *Enforce public access prevention* so that objects could be shared publicly later.

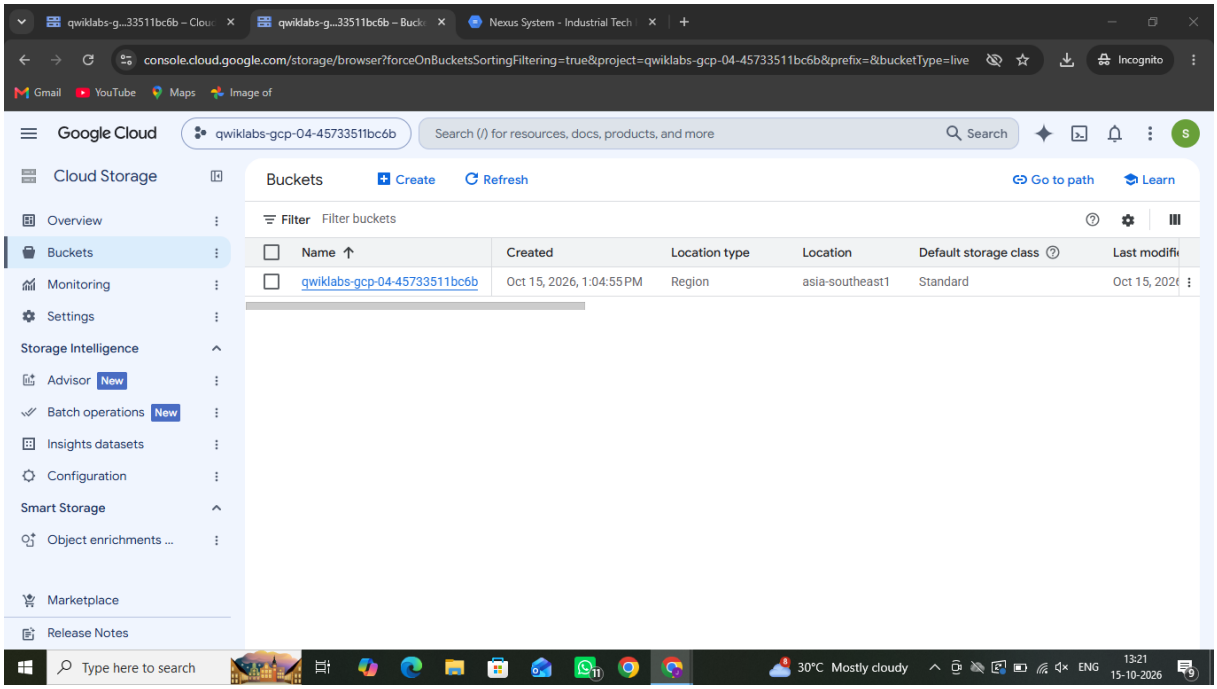


Figure 1: Buckets page showing the new bucket in the asia-southeast1 region with the Standard storage class.

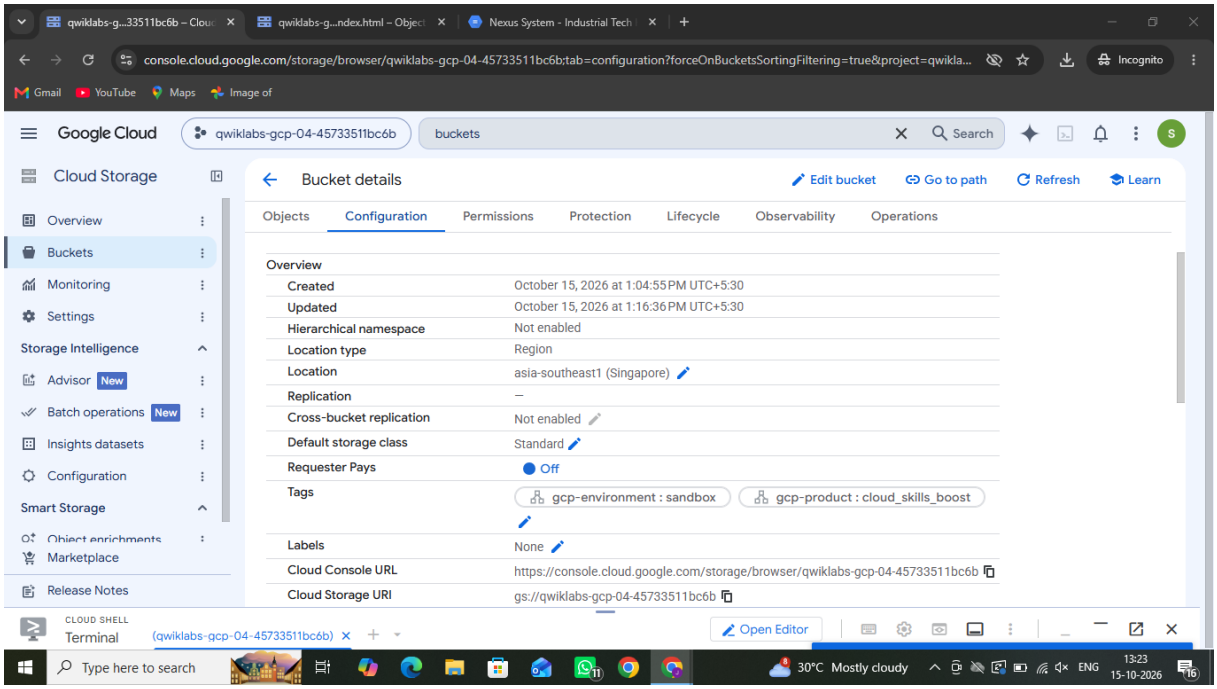


Figure 2: Bucket configuration – location type Region, location asia-southeast1 (Singapore), default storage class Standard, created 15 Oct 2026.

Task 2 – Upload an object

I downloaded the lab's image as **kitten.png**, opened the bucket, and used *Upload* > *Upload files* to add it. The Objects tab lists it as a 132.9 KB image/png object next to the folders created in later steps.

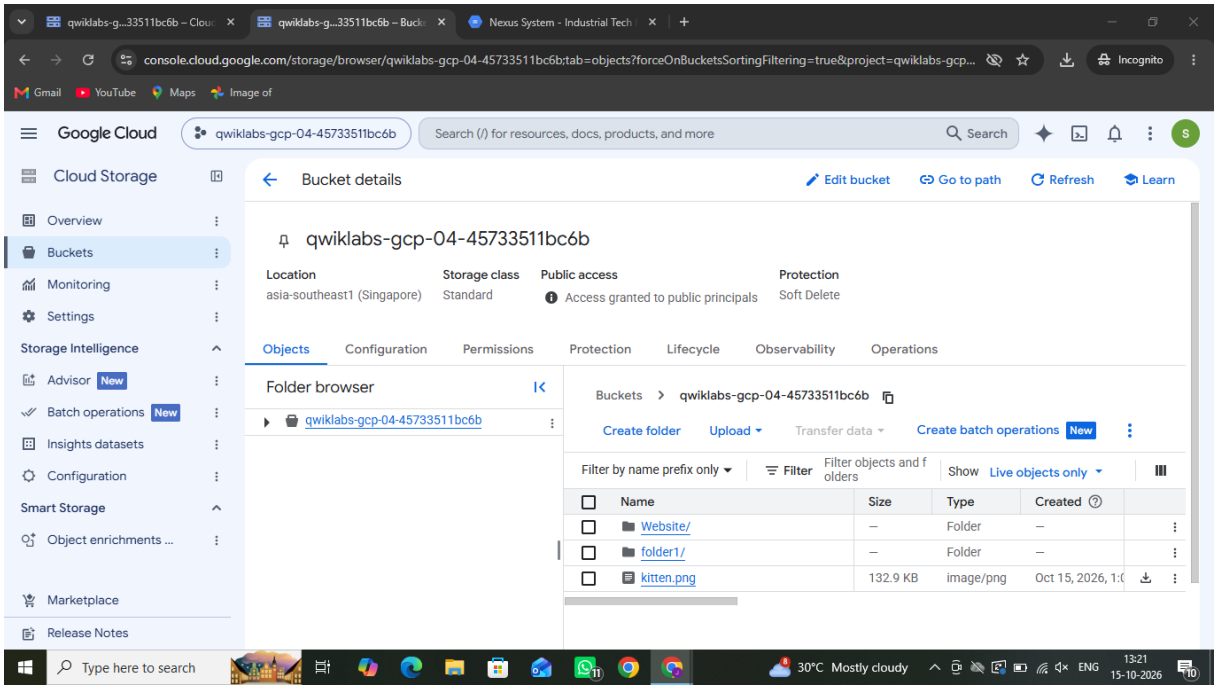


Figure 3: Bucket objects – kitten.png, folder1/ and Website/. The bucket header reads "Access granted to public principals".

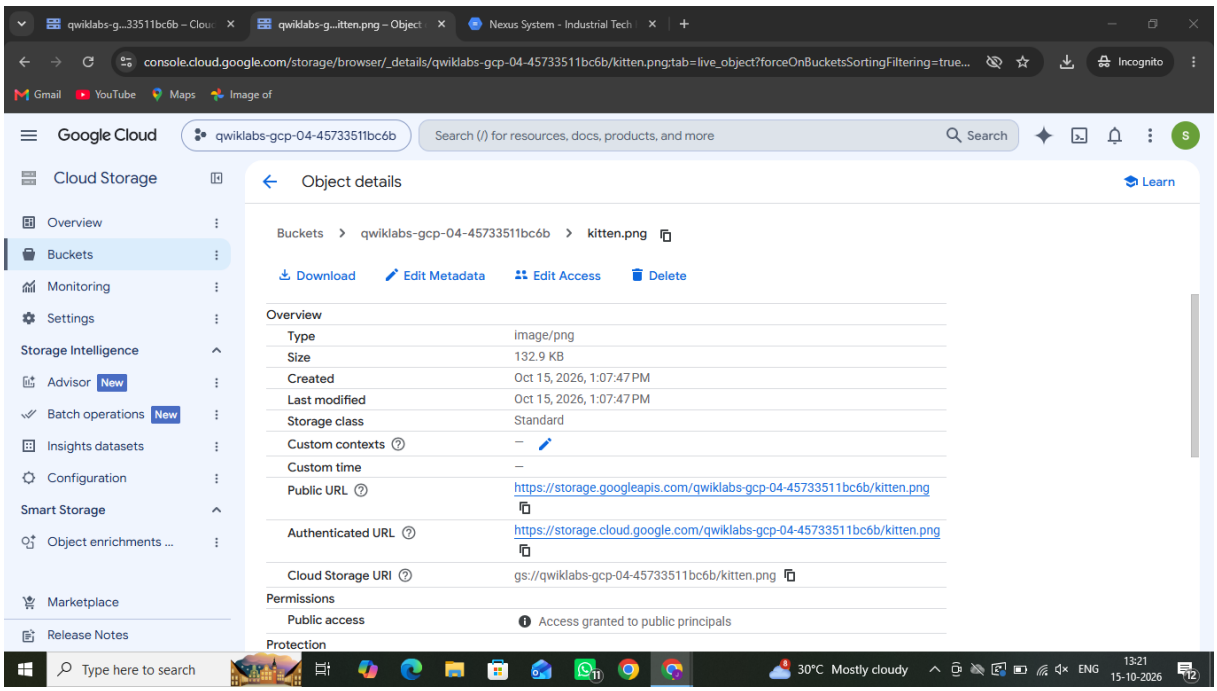


Figure 4: Object details for kitten.png – type image/png, 132.9 KB, Standard class, with its public URL and gs:// URI.

Task 3 – Share the bucket publicly

On the **Permissions** tab I chose *Grant access*, entered **allUsers** as the principal and selected the role **Cloud Storage > Storage Object Viewer**. After saving and confirming *Allow public access*, the objects were readable by anyone.

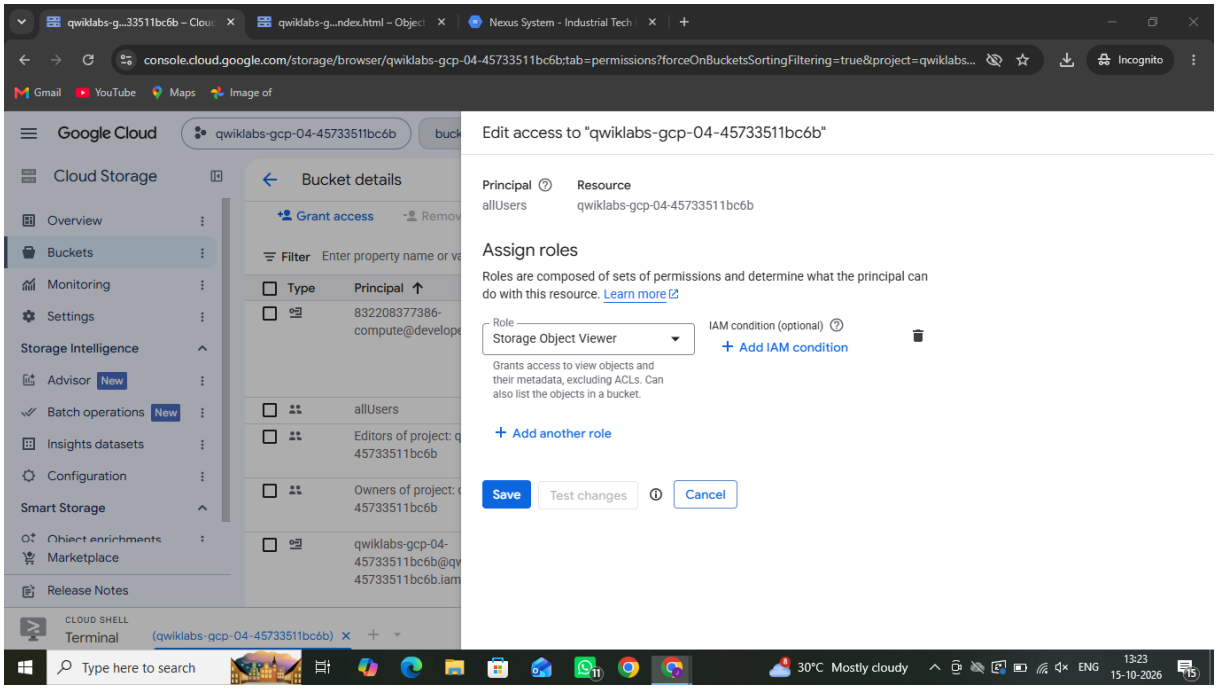


Figure 5: Edit access dialog showing the allUsers principal with the Storage Object Viewer role.

To verify, I opened the object's public URL in a separate tab, in the form `https://storage.googleapis.com/<bucket>/kitten.png`. The image loaded without signing in.

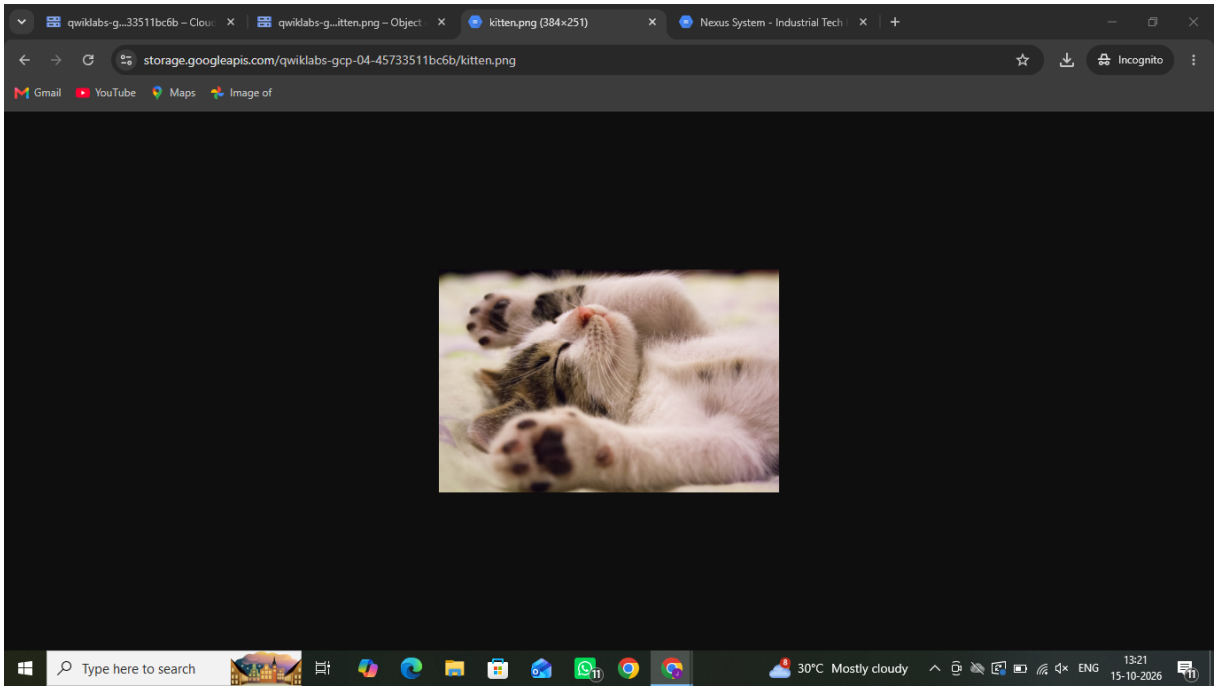


Figure 6: kitten.png served from storage.googleapis.com using the public URL.

Task 4 – Create folders

Cloud Storage organises objects with folders. I used **Create folder** to make **folder1**, then created **folder2** inside it and uploaded a file there. In the folder browser, folder1 shows an expand arrow for its subfolder.

Static website hosting

I also uploaded a static website into a **Website/** folder: an index.html page, JPEG images, a JavaScript file and a CSS stylesheet. Because the bucket allows public reads, the page could be opened directly from its public URL.

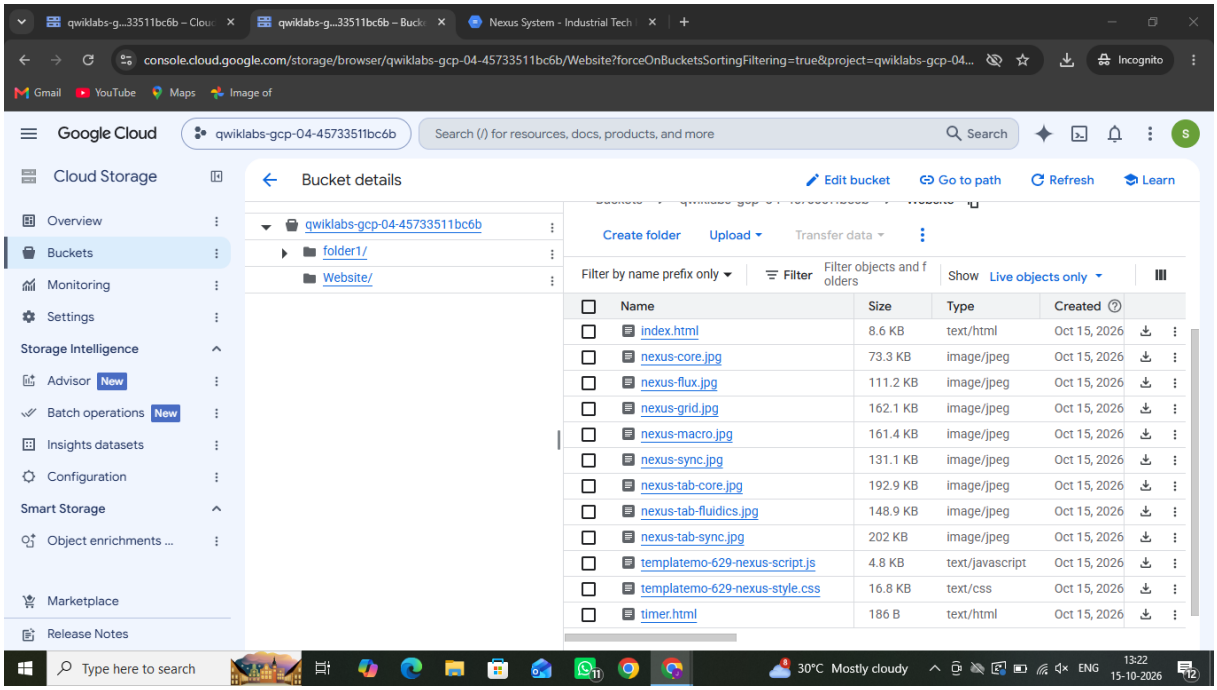


Figure 7: The Website/ folder containing index.html, images, a script and a stylesheet. folder1/ is also visible in the folder browser.

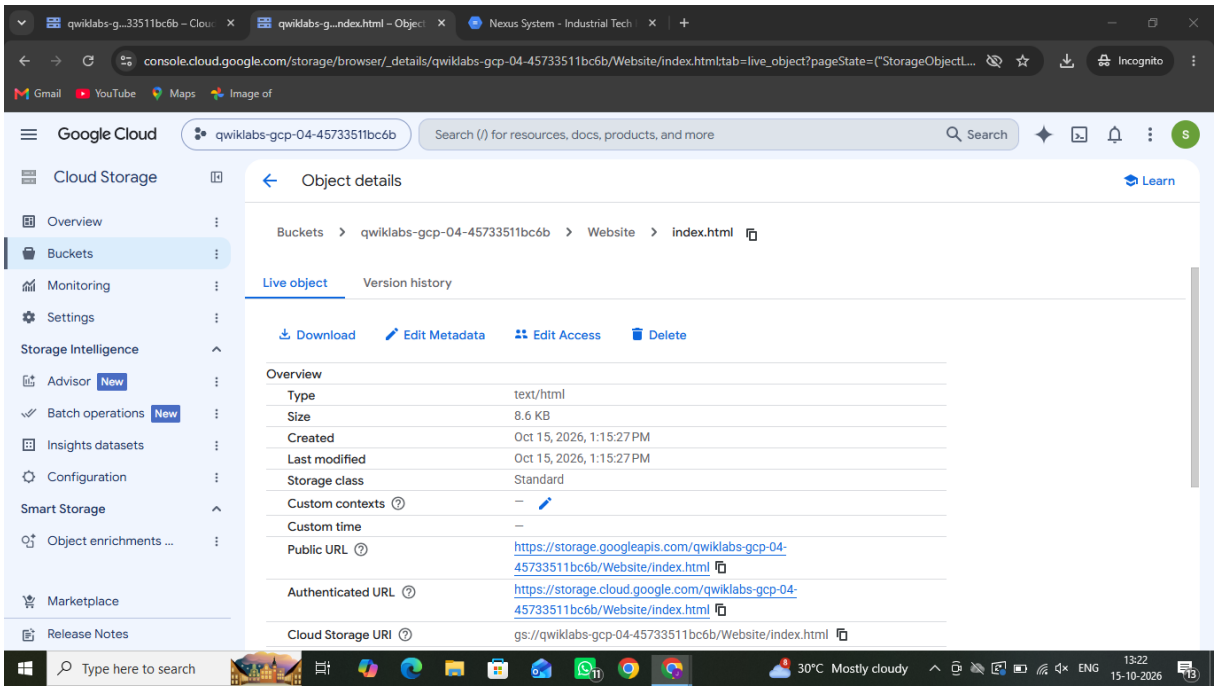


Figure 8: Object details for Website/index.html (text/html, 8.6 KB) with its public URL.

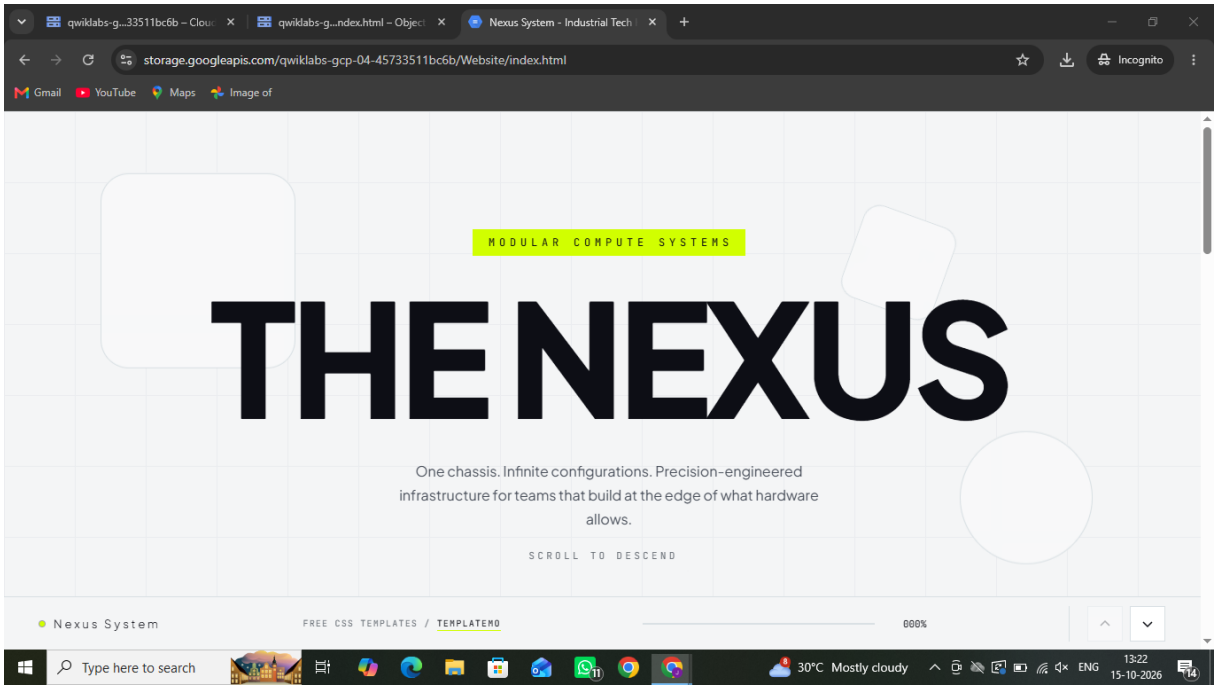


Figure 9: The site rendered in the browser from storage.googleapis.com/<bucket>/Website/index.html.

Task 5 – Delete

To finish, a bucket can be removed by selecting it, clicking **Delete**, and typing **DELETE** to confirm. This permanently deletes the bucket and every object and subfolder in it. The lab environment cleans up the remaining resources when the lab ends.

5. Lab Completion

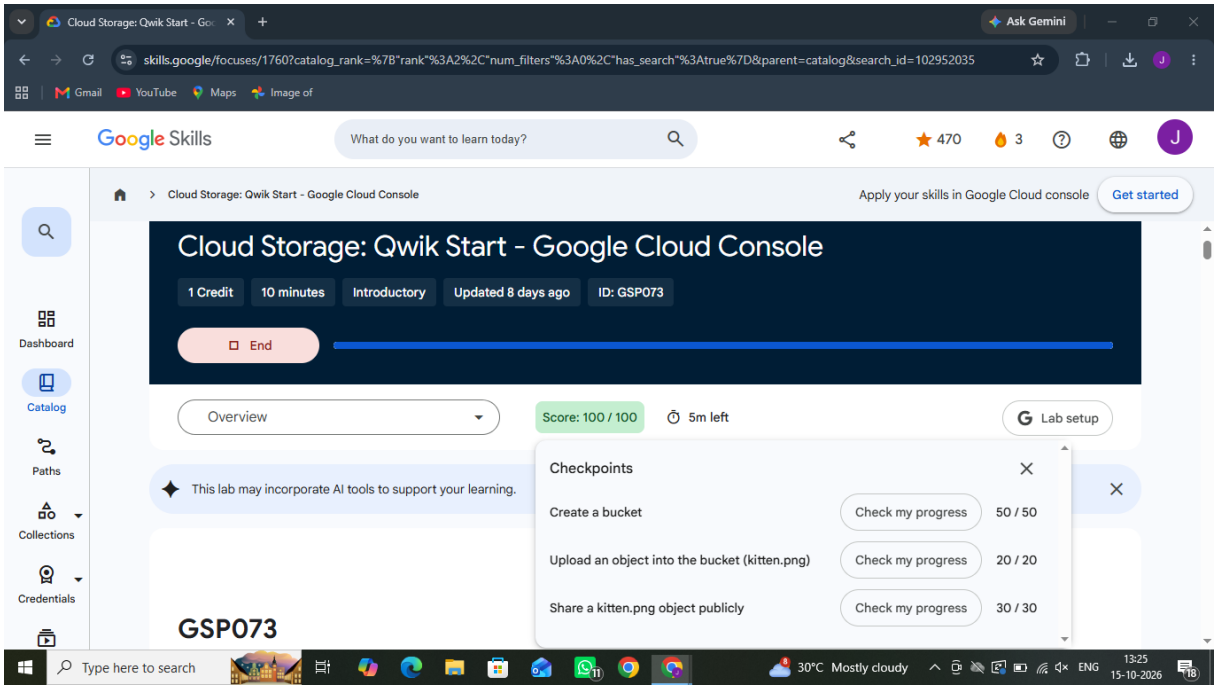


Figure 10: Lab checkpoints – Create a bucket (50/50), Upload an object (20/20), Share kitten.png publicly (30/30). Total score 100/100.

Knowledge-check answers

- **Every bucket must have a unique name across the entire Cloud Storage namespace:** True.
- **Object names must be unique only within a given bucket:** True.

6. Key Takeaways

- Buckets are the basic containers in Cloud Storage. Their names are global, so they must be unique and must not contain sensitive information.
- A bucket's location, default storage class and access control are chosen at creation. Here that was Region (asia-southeast1), Standard and Uniform.
- Object names only need to be unique within their own bucket.
- Granting **allUsers** the **Storage Object Viewer** role makes objects publicly readable, which requires turning off public access prevention.
- Public objects get a URL of the form *storage.googleapis.com/BUCKET/OBJECT*, so a bucket can host static website files.
- Folders in the console help organise objects, and deleting a bucket removes everything inside it, so confirmation is required.

7. Conclusion

The lab was completed with a score of 100/100. I created a Standard regional bucket in asia-southeast1, uploaded and organised objects, and made them publicly accessible with an IAM role, including serving a static page directly from Cloud Storage.